



## ABOUT THIS GUIDE

This educational guide is designed for parents who want to raise emotionally strong, resilient, and self-aware children.

Inspired by Social Development (Parke et al., 2019) and leading research on self-esteem and perfectionism, it offers practical tips, reflection questions, and games to use at home.

## SCIENCE BEHIND PRAISE

| FINDING                                                                                                           | USAGE FOR PARENTS                                        | RESEARCH INSIGHT                                                            |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <br>Self-Esteem Needs Roots      | Praise persistence & strategy, not personality.          | Baumeister & Vohs (2018): self-esteem must come from real effort.           |
| <br>Authenticity Builds Bonds    | Let your child see you make small mistakes too.          | Casale et al. (2019): hiding flaws reduces closeness.                       |
| <br>Emotional Regulation Matters | Help your child name feelings and normalize frustration. | Parke et al. (2019): emotional awareness grows through supportive feedback. |

A healthy self-concept grows when confidence is grounded in effort, authenticity, and emotional understanding.

Baumeister and Vohs (2018) remind us that inflated self-esteem can lead to defensiveness and aggression when challenged, while Casale et al. (2019) show how the need to appear perfect erodes real connection and self-acceptance.

## TWO KINDS OF PRAISE



**Panel 1:** Eli, you're so smart! You always get it right!

**Panel 2 (a week later):** If I can't do this fast, maybe I'm not smart anymore...

**Panel 3:** Sarah, I really liked how u kept trying different ways until solved

**Panel 4 (a week later):** I did better this time! My practice helped.

**Panel 5:** I don't get it... I'm supposed to be smart.

**Panel 6:** Praise that focuses on effort builds resilience. Praise that focuses on talent builds fear of failure.

Every word we use to praise our children shapes how they see themselves.

# FAMILY GROWTH GAMES



## FAILURE FRIDAY

Share a funny mistake and what you learned



## EMOTION SWAP

Guess how family members felt during their day



## EFFORT JAR

Add a pebble every time someone tries again after failing



## COMPLIMENT TAG

Compliment a behavior, not an outcome

Confidence grows from trying, not from never making mistakes.

# PARENT REFLECTION



Do I praise my child's effort more than their intelligence?



Do I model calmness when I make mistakes?



Do I let my child solve problems before stepping in?



Do I talk openly about how I feel when things go wrong?



Do I encourage persistence rather than perfection?

# REFERENCES

Baumeister, R. F., & Vohs, K. D. (2018). *Revisiting our reappraisal of the (surprisingly few) benefits of high self-esteem. Perspectives on Psychological Science, 13*(2), 137-143.

Casale, S., Fioravanti, G., Baldi, V., Flett, G. L., & Hewitt, P. L. (2019). *Narcissism, perfectionistic self-presentation, and relationship satisfaction from a dyadic perspective. Self and Identity, 18*(8), 948-966.

Parke, R. D., Roisman, G. I., & Rose, A. J. (2019). *Social Development* (2nd ed.). Wiley.

# GROWING REAL CONFIDENCE

How Everyday Praise Shapes Children's Self-Esteem